

Carson Benge

23.2 years old
PPI Pick Eligible

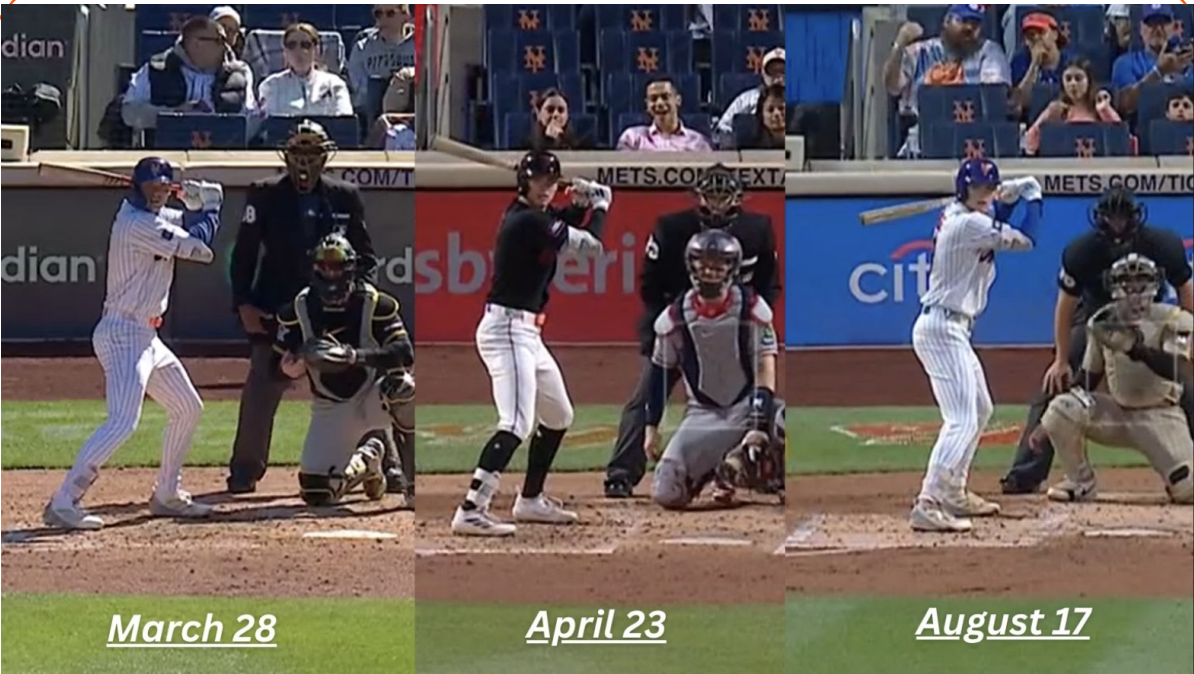
#3
Bats: Left
Throws: Right

G	AVG/OBP/SLG	HR	RBI	SB	BsR	wRC+	DRS	fWAR
139	.274/.335/.413	16	54	22	3.9	109	3	3.1

THE TURNING POINT

Carson Benge is a prime example of how in-season mechanical changes can increase a rookie's offensive value. Benge did not come out of the gates strong; instead, May was the month the turnaround began for Benge. In March and April, Benge was getting his feet under him against major league pitching, struggling to the tune of a 48 wRC+ and a xwOBA of .286. Benge made a noticeable swing change heading into May, and the results followed. From May 1st onward, Benge slashed .291/.353/.440 with a 122 wRC+ and a xwOBA of .345. Benge is lifting the ball more and has optimized his bat path to produce more consistent hard contact with the barrel.

STANCE AND SETUP CHANGES



Benge's pre-pitch stance progression, March 28–August 17, 2026

Over the course of the year, Benge closed his stance while also resting his bat on his shoulder, possibly to relax his hands during his pre-pitch setup. These were pretty significant in-season changes, changing his stance to be 21 degrees more closed and backing off the plate more. Being closed could allow Benge to be able to fire his hips a bit earlier before the barrel comes through the zone, given the nature of his short, compact swing. Benge's swing is 7 inches shorter than MLB average, but he is taking advantage of it by staying closed longer and hitting the ball further out in front of the plate.

ELITE ARM AND OVERALL UPSIDE

Benge is an above-average athlete with the tools to become an above-average defender in right field, thanks to his average range and elite arm. Benge ranks in the 100th percentile in arm value and the 99th percentile for arm strength. Benge has already made several notable assists from right field this year, and Benge shows an ability to work around the baseball, create momentum toward the bag, quickly flip his hips and deliver a strong throw. He also shows good sprint speed and above-average baserunning instincts, adding 3.9 baserunning runs and 22 stolen bases this season.

Benge's in-season stance adjustment and ability to adapt to Major League pitching have raised his offensive ceiling, while his athleticism, arm strength and baserunning give him multiple ways to provide value. The next test will be whether those offensive improvements are sustainable as pitchers continue to adjust. At the same time, additional progress in his reads and routes could allow his elite arm to play even more consistently in right field.